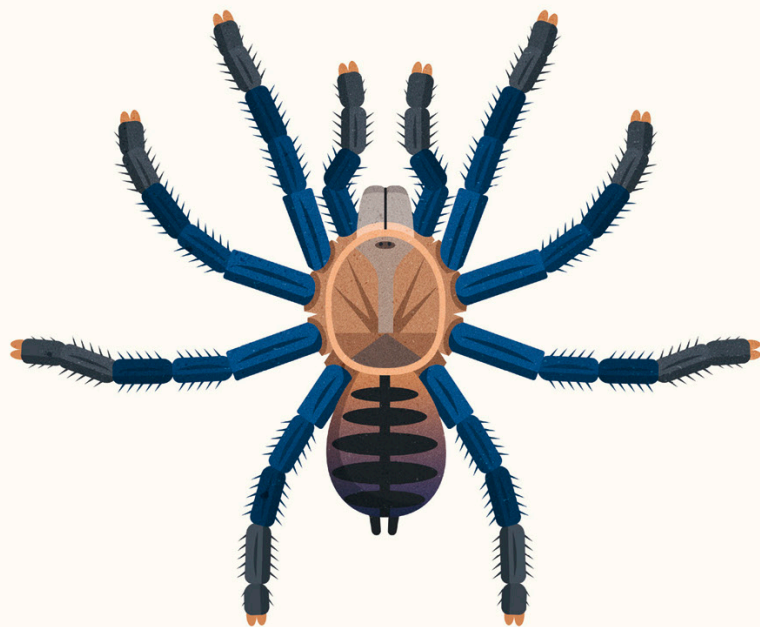




Tarantula

Tarantulas are super-sized spiders. The biggest would cover a dinner plate! Unlike other spiders, they don't build webs to catch food, but hunt down large insects, frogs, and mice. Their eight hairy feet have sensors that can feel tiny vibrations made by prey.

Tarantulas are named after Taranto, a town in Italy. The people there said the only way to survive the venom from a spider bite was to do a fast dance, called the Tarantella. In fact, most tarantulas are harmless to humans. Some do have a nasty defence though. Using their back legs, they scrape super-itchy hairs from their body and flick a cloud of them into the face of their attacker. These irritate the predator's eyes and nose.



Cobalt blue tarantula,
Southeast Asia

